HELSINGIC CHARACTER

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HELSINGIC CHARACTER, a peculiar kind of character, found inferited on flones in the province of Helfingia s the Runic and Hellingic characters may be easily transformed into each other.

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the ſixth for the pagans, and the ſeventh for the hypocrites of all religions.

Among Chriſtians, there are two controverted queſtions in regard to hell; the one concerns locality, the other the duration of its torments. The locality of hell, and the reality of its fire, began firſt to be controverted by Origen. That father, interpreting the ſcripture account metaphorically, makes hell to conſiſt not in external puniſhments, but in a conſciouſneſs or ſenſe of guilt, and a remembrance of paſt pleaſures. Among the moderns, Mr Whiſton advanced a new hypotheſis. According to him, the comets are ſo many hells appointed in their orbits alternately to carry the damned into the confines of the ſun, there to be ſcorched by its violent heat, and then to return with them beyond the orb of Saturn, there to ſtarve them in theſe cold and diſmal regions. Another modern author, not ſatisfied with any hypotheſis hitherto advanced, aſſigns the ſun to be the local hell. As to the ſecond queſtion, *viz.* the duration of hell-torments, we have Origen again at the head of thoſe who deny that they are eternal; it being that father's opinion, that not only men, but devils, after a due courſe of puniſhment ſuitable to their reſpective crimes, ſhall be pardoned and reſtored to heaven. The chief principle upon which Origen built his opinion, was the nature of puniſhment, which he took to be emendatory, applied only as phyſic for the recovery of the patient's health. The chief objection to the eternity of hell torments among modern writers, is the diſproportion between temporary crimes and eternal puniſhments. Thoſe who maintain the affirmative, ground their opinions on ſcripture accounts, which repreſent the pains of hell under the figure of a worm which never dies, and a fire which is not quenched; as alſo upon the words, "Theſe ſhall go away into everlaſting puniſhment, but "the righteous into life eternal.

HELLEBORUS, HELLEBORE, in botany, a genus of the polyandria polygynia claſs. It has no calix; the petals are five or more; the nectarium is tubular and bilabiated; and the capſule contains many ſeeds. There are five ſpecies, two of them natives of Britain, *viz.* the fœtidus, or great baſtard black hellebore; and the viridis, or wild black hellebore. The hellebore, when taken in large quantities, is poiſonous; but the root, in ſmall doſes, is ſuppoſed to attenuate the humours, and to promote urinary and uterine diſcharges.

HELLENISM, in matters of language, a phraſe in the idiom, genius, or conſtruction of the Greek tongue.

This word is only uſed when ſpeaking of the authors who, writing in a different language, expreſs themſelves in a phraſeology peculiar to the Greek.

HELLENISTIC, or HELENISTIC LANGUAGE, that uſed by the Grecian Jews who lived in Egypt and other parts where the Greek tongue prevailed. In this language it is ſaid the Septuagint was written, and alſo the books of the New Teſtament; and that it was thus denominated to ſhew that it was Greek filled with Hebraiſms and Syriaciſms.

HELLESPONT, the entrance of the ſtreights which divides Aſia from Europe, and paſſes from the Archipelago to Conſtantinople. It is now called the Dardanelles, and is about two miles wide.

HELM *of a ſhip*, is a piece of timber faſtened into the rudder, which comes forward into the ſteerage, or place where the perſon at the helm ſteers the ſhip, by holding the whipſtaff in his hand, which is joined to the helm. They begin however to be left off, ſteering-wheels being uſed in their room.

There are ſeveral terms in the ſea-language relating to the helm; as, *bear up the helm*; that is, let the ſhip go more large before the wind. *Helm amid ſhip*, or *right the helm*; that is, keep it even with the middle of the ſhip. *Port the helm*, put it over the the left ſide of the ſhip. *Starboard the helm*, put it on the right ſide of the ſhip.

HELMET, an ancient defenſive armour worn by horſemen both in war and in tournaments. It covered both the head and face, only leaving an aperture in the front ſecured by bars, which was called the viſor.

HELMINTHOLITHUS, in natural hiſtory, a name given by Linnæus to petrified bodies reſembling worms.

Of theſe he reckons four genera. 1. Petrified lithophyta, found in the mountains of Sweden. 2. Petrified ſhells. 3. Petriſied zoophytes. 4. Petrified reptiles.

HELMONT, a town of the Netherlands, in the province of Dutch Brabant, ſituated on the river Aa: E. long. 5° 40′, N. lat. 51° 30′.

HELMSTAT, a town of Germany, in the circle of Lower Saxony, and dukedom of Brunſwic: E. long. 11° 15′, N. lat. 52° 20′.

HELOTS, in Grecian antiquity, the inhabitants of Helos, a town of Laconia, conquered by the Spartans; who made them all priſoners of war, and reduced them into the condition of ſlaves.

The freemen of Sparta were forbidden the exerciſe of any mean or mechanical employment, and therefore the whole care of ſupplying the city with neceſſaries devolved upon the Helots.

HELSINGFORD a port-town of Sweden, ſituated on the gulph of Finland, in 24° 6′ E. long. and 60° 8′ N. lat.

HELSINGIA, a province of Sweden, bounded by the Bothnic gulph on the eaſt, and by Dalecarlia on the weſt.

HELSINGIC CHARACTER, a peculiar kind of character, found inſcribed on ſtones in the province of Helſingia: the Runic and Helſingic characters may be eaſily tranſormed into each other.

HELSTON, a borough of Cornwall, nine miles ſouth-weſt of Falmouth: it ſends two members to parliament.

HELVOETSLUYS, a port-town of the united Netherlands, ſituated in the iſland of Voorn, in the province of Holland, five miles ſouth of the Briel: it is one of the beſt harbours in Holland, and that to which the Engliſh packet alway goes.

HEMEROBIUS, in zoology, a genus of inſects of the neuroptera order, the characters of which are theſe: The mouth is furniſhed with two teeth; the palpi are four; the wings are deflected, but not plaited; and

Figure 1: *
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